

Getting Started with pgscatalogcolors

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```
library(pgscatalogcolors)
library(ggplot2)
```

What ancestry acronyms are available?

The package maps **19 ancestry categories** defined by the PGS Catalog ancestry documentation. Call `pgscatalog_ancestry_info()` to see the full lookup table:

```
pgscatalog_ancestry_info()
#>   acronym          ancestry pop_group  color
#> 1    ABO      Aboriginal Australian    DIV #999999
#> 2    AAM African American or Afro-Caribbean AFR #F9DA49
#> 3    AFR      African unspecified    AFR #F9DA49
#> 4    ASN      Asian unspecified    ASN #B25928
#> 5    CAS      Central Asian    ASN #B25928
#> 6    EAS      East Asian    EAS #68AD57
#> 7    EUR      European    EUR #377EB8
#> 8    MID      Greater Middle Eastern    MID #5DCBCF
#> 9    HIS      Hispanic or Latin American    HIS #D1352B
#> 10   AMR      Native American    DIV #999999
#> 11   NON      Not Reported    NON #BBBBBB
#> 12   OCE      Oceanian    DIV #999999
#> 13   OTH      Other    DIV #999999
#> 14   ADA      Other admixed ancestry    DIV #999999
#> 15   SAS      South Asian    SAS #984EA4
#> 16   SEA      South East Asian    ASN #B25928
#> 17   SAF      Sub-Saharan African    AFR #F9DA49
#> 18   MIE Multi-Ancestry including Europeans    MIE #E887BD
#> 19   MEE Multi-Ancestry excluding Europeans    MEE #EF8632
```

The columns are:

Column	Description
acronym	The exact string your data column must contain
ancestry	Full PGS Catalog ancestry label
pop_group	Broader population group abbreviation (1000G/HGDP-style)
color	Hex color assigned to that acronym

What does my data frame need?

Your data frame needs **one column whose values are ancestry acronyms** — the exact strings from the `acronym` column above (case-sensitive). The column can have any name; you point `ggplot2` to it with `aes(color = <your_column>)`.

```
# Minimal working example
df <- data.frame(
  sample_id = paste0("s", 1:6),
  pgs_score = c(0.42, -0.11, 0.87, 0.03, -0.55, 0.29),
  ancestry = c("EUR", "AFR", "EAS", "SAS", "HIS", "MID")
  #           ^-- must match acronyms exactly
)
df
#>   sample_id pgs_score ancestry
#> 1         s1      0.42      EUR
#> 2         s2     -0.11      AFR
#> 3         s3      0.87      EAS
#> 4         s4      0.03      SAS
#> 5         s5     -0.55      HIS
#> 6         s6      0.29      MID
```

The `ancestry` column values must be **character or factor** — numeric codes will not match. The column does **not** need to contain all 19 acronyms; only the ones present in your data are plotted.

PGS odds ratio forest plot

A common use case is plotting the odds ratio (OR) of a polygenic score across ancestry groups, with ancestry on the y-axis and the OR on the x-axis. Each point is coloured by ancestry using the PGS Catalog palette.

```
set.seed(42)
groups <- c("EUR", "AFR", "EAS", "SAS", "HIS", "MID", "MIE", "MEE")

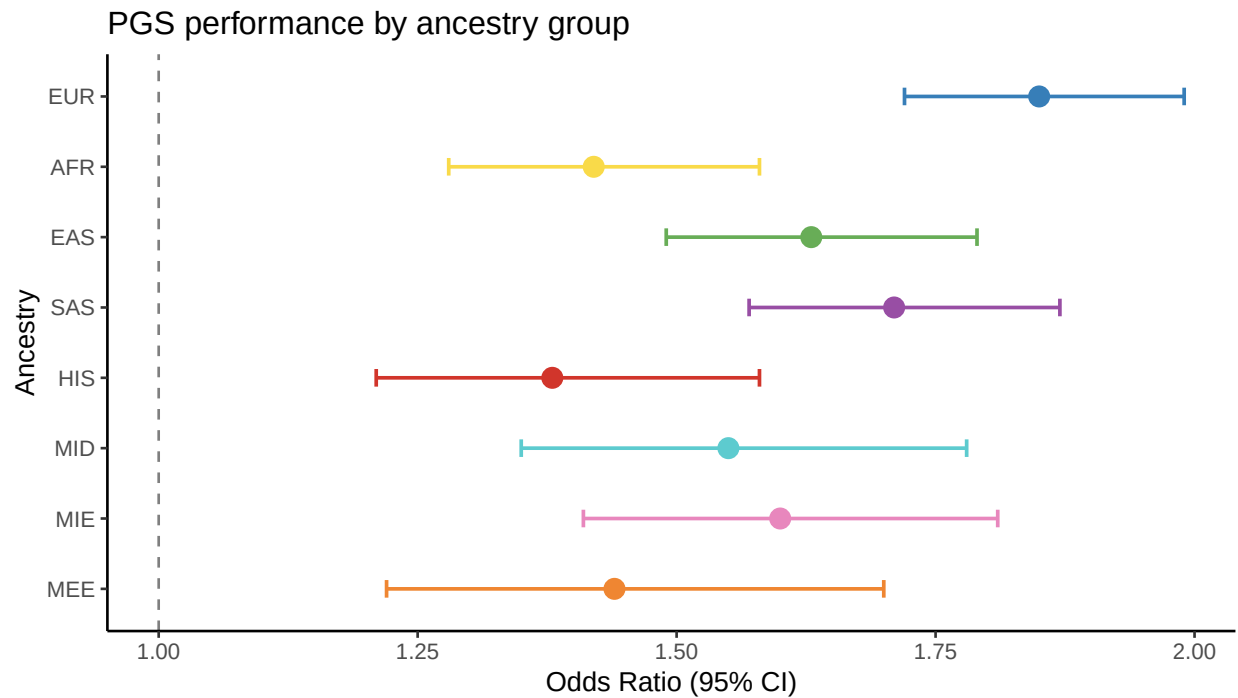
forest_df <- data.frame(
  ancestry = factor(groups, levels = rev(groups)),
  OR       = c(1.85, 1.42, 1.63, 1.71, 1.38, 1.55, 1.60, 1.44),
  lower    = c(1.72, 1.28, 1.49, 1.57, 1.21, 1.35, 1.41, 1.22),
  upper    = c(1.99, 1.58, 1.79, 1.87, 1.58, 1.78, 1.81, 1.70)
)

ggplot(forest_df, aes(x = OR, y = ancestry, color = ancestry)) +
  geom_vline(xintercept = 1, linetype = "dashed", colour = "grey50") +
  geom_errorbarh(aes(xmin = lower, xmax = upper), height = 0.25, linewidth = 0.7) +
  geom_point(size = 3.5) +
  scale_color_pgscatalog() +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = seq(1, 2, 0.25)) +
  labs(
```

```

x      = "Odds Ratio (95% CI)",
y      = "Ancestry",
title  = "PGS performance by ancestry group"
) +
theme_classic() +
theme(legend.position = "none")

```



Basic scatter plot

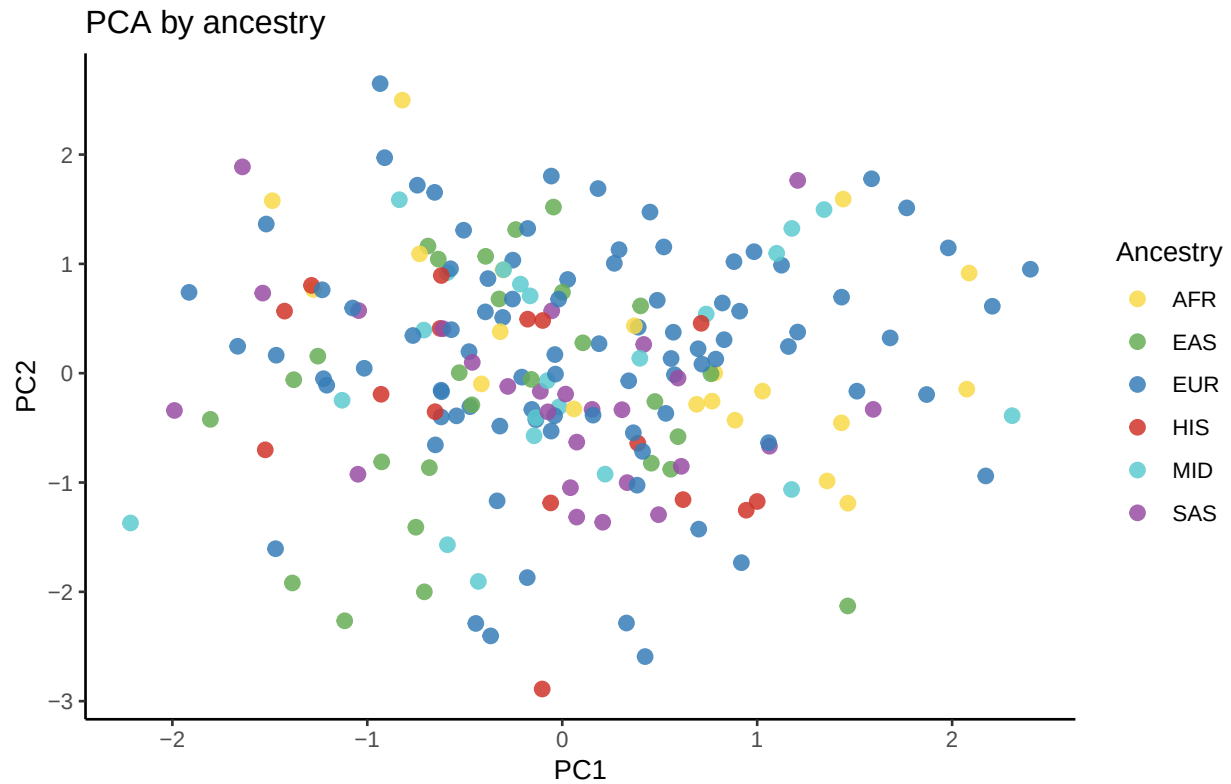
```

set.seed(1)
n <- 200
grp <- c("EUR", "AFR", "EAS", "SAS", "HIS", "MID")

df <- data.frame(
  PC1 = rnorm(n),
  PC2 = rnorm(n),
  ancestry = sample(grp, n, replace = TRUE,
                    prob = c(0.40, 0.15, 0.15, 0.12, 0.10, 0.08))
)

ggplot(df, aes(PC1, PC2, color = ancestry)) +
  geom_point(size = 2.5, alpha = 0.85) +
  scale_color_pgs catalog() +
  labs(title = "PCA by ancestry", color = "Ancestry") +
  theme_classic()

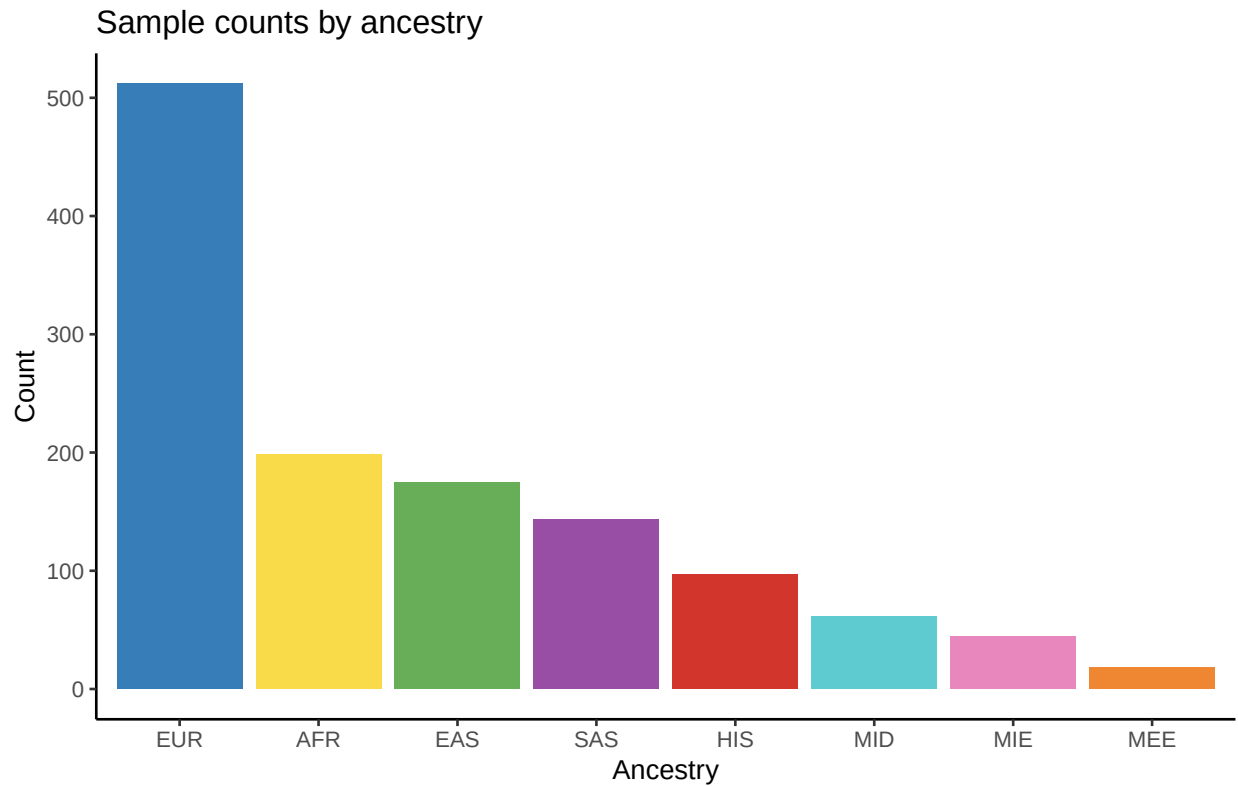
```



Bar chart (fill aesthetic)

```
counts <- data.frame(
  ancestry = c("EUR", "AFR", "EAS", "SAS", "HIS", "MID", "MIE", "MEE"),
  n        = c(512, 198, 175, 143, 97, 61, 44, 18)
)

ggplot(counts, aes(reorder(ancestry, -n), n, fill = ancestry)) +
  geom_col() +
  scale_fill_pgscatalog() +
  labs(x = "Ancestry", y = "Count", title = "Sample counts by ancestry") +
  theme_classic() +
  theme(legend.position = "none")
```

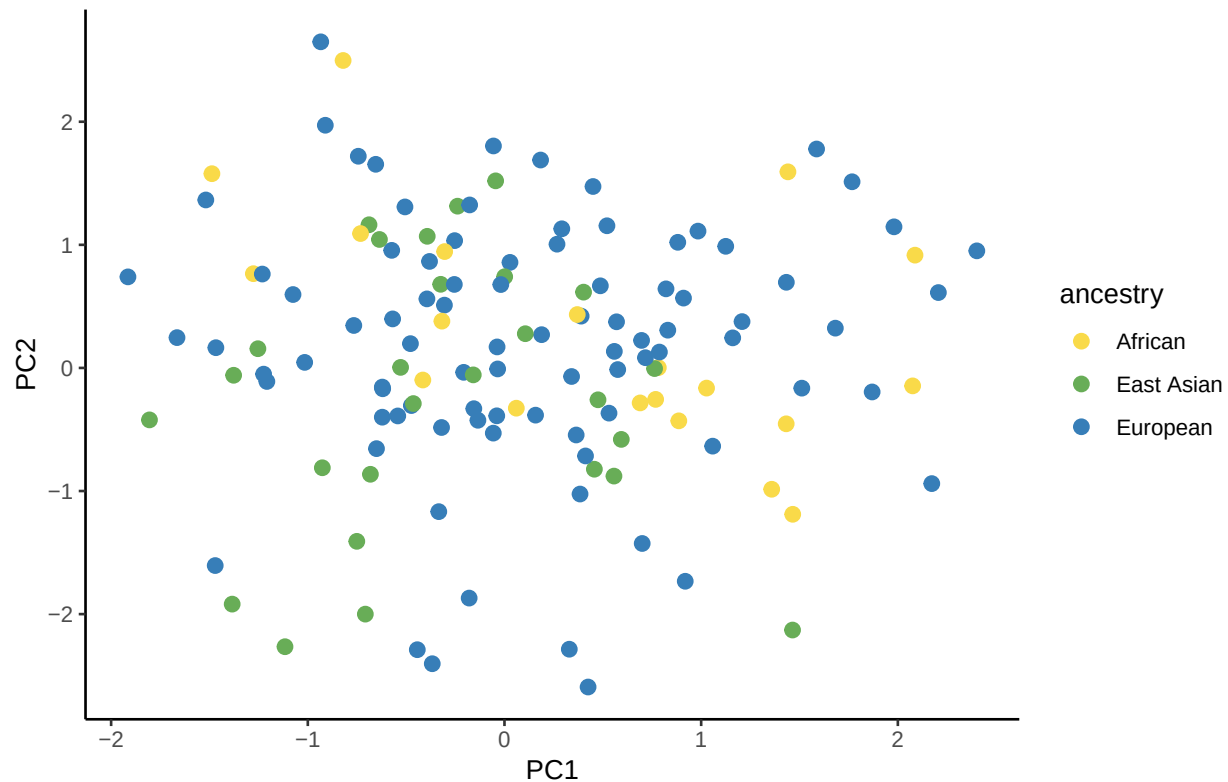


Using `scale_color_manual()` directly

If you need more control (e.g., custom legend labels), use `pgscatalog_scale_values()` to get only the colors for groups in your data:

```
my_groups <- c("EUR", "AFR", "EAS")

ggplot(df[df$ancestry %in% my_groups, ], aes(PC1, PC2, color = ancestry)) +
  geom_point(size = 2.5) +
  scale_color_manual(
    values = pgscatalog_scale_values(my_groups),
    labels = c(AFR = "African", EAS = "East Asian", EUR = "European")
  ) +
  theme_classic()
```



Checking colors programmatically

```
# Look up specific colors by acronym
pgscatalog_cols("EUR", "AFR", "EAS")
#>      EUR      AFR      EAS
#> "#377EB8" "#F9DA49" "#68AD57"

# Check whether your acronyms are all recognized before plotting
my_data_groups <- c("EUR", "AFR", "XYZ") # "XYZ" is not a valid acronym
pgscatalog_scale_values(my_data_groups) # warns about unknown acronyms
#> Warning in pgscatalog_scale_values(my_data_groups): Unknown acronyms (will use
#> grey): XYZ
#>      EUR      AFR      XYZ
#> "#377EB8" "#F9DA49" "#999999"
```

Color vision deficiency

The PGS Catalog palette was not originally designed with color vision deficiency (CVD) in mind. Use `pgscatalog_cvd()` to simulate how the palette appears under deuteranopia, protanopia, and tritanopia, and to identify which ancestry pairs fall below a perceptual distance threshold (CIEDE2000 delta-E).

```
library(colorspace)
library(farver)

# Returns a data frame of flagged pairs, sorted by delta-E ascending
cvd_df <- pgscatalog_cvd(threshold = 20)
print(cvd_df[, c("cvd_type", "acronym1", "acronym2", "delta_e")])
#>      cvd_type acronym1 acronym2 delta_e
```

#> 1	deuteranopia	ASN	HIS	1.7
#> 2	deuteranopia	EUR	SAS	4.0
#> 3	deuteranopia	MID	MIE	5.4
#> 4	protanopia	ASN	HIS	5.5
#> 5	protanopia	EAS	MEE	6.0
#> 6	protanopia	MID	NON	6.1
#> 7	tritanopia	ASN	HIS	7.7
#> 8	deuteranopia	NON	MIE	7.9
#> 9	deuteranopia	ABO	MIE	8.8
#> 10	tritanopia	MIE	MEE	8.9
#> 11	deuteranopia	ABO	NON	9.8
#> 12	protanopia	ABO	NON	9.8
#> 13	tritanopia	ABO	NON	9.8
#> 14	deuteranopia	EAS	MEE	10.0
#> 15	protanopia	EUR	SAS	10.5
#> 16	deuteranopia	EAS	HIS	11.4
#> 17	deuteranopia	MID	NON	11.4
#> 18	protanopia	EUR	MIE	11.5
#> 19	deuteranopia	ASN	EAS	12.4
#> 20	tritanopia	EAS	MID	13.1
#> 21	protanopia	ABO	MID	13.2
#> 22	deuteranopia	AAM	MEE	13.6
#> 23	protanopia	MID	MIE	13.7
#> 24	tritanopia	EAS	EUR	13.8
#> 25	protanopia	ABO	MIE	13.9
#> 26	deuteranopia	ABO	MID	14.0
#> 27	tritanopia	ASN	SAS	14.3
#> 28	deuteranopia	HIS	MEE	15.5
#> 29	tritanopia	ASN	MEE	16.1
#> 30	protanopia	NON	MIE	16.4
#> 31	tritanopia	HIS	MEE	16.5
#> 32	protanopia	AAM	EAS	16.7
#> 33	deuteranopia	ASN	MEE	17.0
#> 34	protanopia	ASN	MEE	18.2
#> 35	tritanopia	AAM	NON	18.6
#> 36	tritanopia	AAM	MIE	18.8
#> 37	protanopia	AAM	MEE	19.2
#> 38	deuteranopia	ABO	EAS	19.3

Delta-E thresholds to interpret the results:

Delta-E	Interpretation
< 2.3	Perceptually identical under that CVD type
2.3 – 10	Difficult to distinguish, especially for small plot elements
10 – 20	Potentially confusable; consider a supplementary encoding

Known problematic pairs

The most severe conflicts in the palette are:

Deuteranopia (red-green; affects ~8% of males — the most clinically relevant type):

- **ASN / HIS** — delta-E **1.7** (perceptually identical; brown and red become almost the same olive-brown)
- **EUR / SAS** — delta-E **4.0** (blue and purple converge strongly)

- MID / MIE — delta-E **5.4**
- NON / MIE — delta-E **7.9**

Protanopia (red-green):

- ASN / HIS — delta-E **5.5**
- EAS / MEE — delta-E **6.0**
- MID / NON — delta-E **6.1**

Tritanopia (blue-yellow; rare, < 0.01%):

- MIE / MEE — delta-E **8.9**
- ASN / HIS — delta-E **7.7**

Normal vision (included for completeness):

- ABO / NON — delta-E **9.8** (both grey by design)
- ASN / HIS — delta-E **12.5**

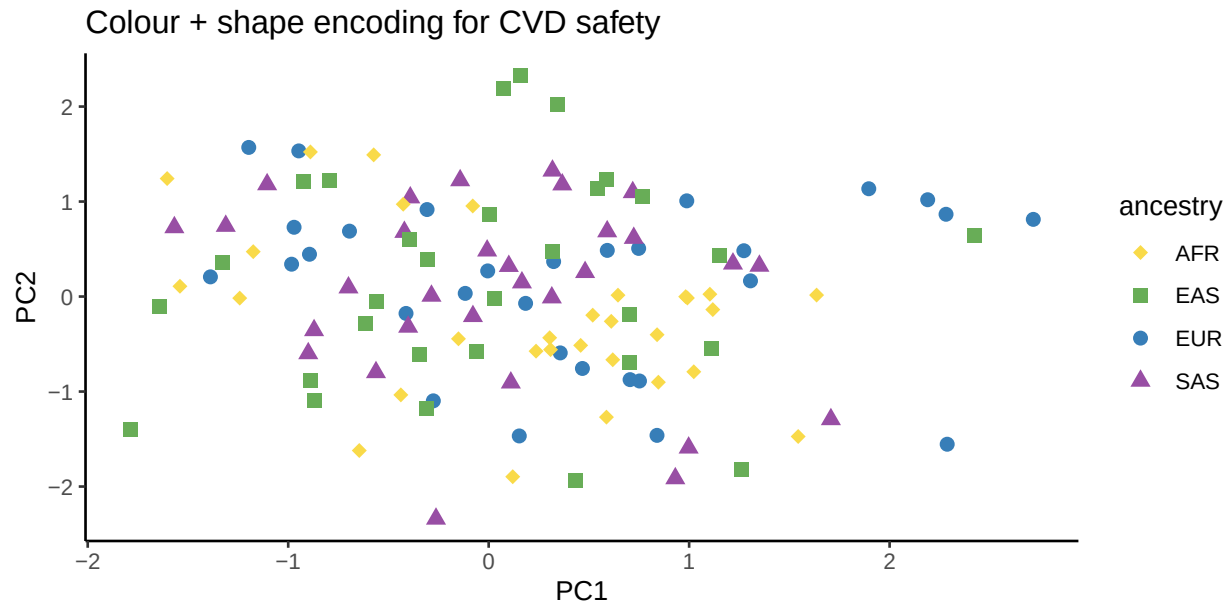
Recommendations

When a plot includes ancestry groups that form a problematic pair, supplement colour with a second visual encoding:

```
set.seed(7)
groups <- c("EUR", "SAS", "EAS", "AFR") # EUR/SAS are a deuteranopia risk pair

df_cvd <- data.frame(
  PC1      = rnorm(120),
  PC2      = rnorm(120),
  ancestry = rep(groups, each = 30)
)

# Add shape mapping so EUR and SAS are distinguishable without colour
ggplot(df_cvd, aes(PC1, PC2, color = ancestry, shape = ancestry)) +
  geom_point(size = 2.5) +
  scale_color_pgscale() +
  scale_shape_manual(values = c(EUR = 16, SAS = 17, EAS = 15, AFR = 18)) +
  labs(title = "Colour + shape encoding for CVD safety") +
  theme_classic()
```



What if my labels have typos or inconsistent formatting?

Use `pgscatalog_match()` to fuzzy-match a column of messy ancestry labels to their PGS Catalog acronyms. Matching tries exact acronym, then exact full name, then edit-distance fuzzy matching — in that order.

```
messy <- c("EUR", "eur", "european", "East Asian", "east_asian", "EAST ASIAN")
pgscatalog_match(messy, quiet = TRUE)
#> [1] "EUR" "EUR" "EUR" "EAS" "EAS" "EAS"
```

Fuzzy matches always produce a warning so you can verify them. The `max_dist` argument (default 3) controls how many edits are allowed — lower values are stricter:

```
# Default max_dist = 3
pgscatalog_match(c("Europeen", "sas", "Sub-Saharan African"))
#> Warning: Fuzzy matches accepted (verify these are correct):
#> "Europeen" -> EUR
#> [1] "EUR" "SAS" "SAF"

# Stricter: only accept 1-edit differences
pgscatalog_match(c("Europeen", "sas", "Sub-Saharan African"), max_dist = 1)
#> Warning: Fuzzy matches accepted (verify these are correct):
#> "Europeen" -> EUR
#> [1] "EUR" "SAS" "SAF"

# More lenient: accept up to 5 edits
pgscatalog_match(c("Afrikan", "sth_asian"), max_dist = 5)
#> Warning: Fuzzy matches accepted (verify these are correct):
#> "Afrikan" -> AFR
#> "sth_asian" -> SAS
#> [1] "AFR" "SAS"
```

Labels with no match within `max_dist` return NA with a warning:

```
pgscatalog_match(c("EUR", "martian", "unknown_ancestry"))
#> Warning: No match found (returned NA) for:
#> "martian"
```

```
#> "unknown_ancestry"
#> Call pgscatalog_ancestry_info() to see valid labels.
#> [1] "EUR" NA NA
```

The typical workflow is to call `pgscatalog_match()` once to add a clean acronym column, then pass that column to the `ggplot2` scales:

```
df_messy <- data.frame(
  sample_id = paste0("s", 1:6),
  pgs_score = c(0.42, -0.11, 0.87, 0.03, -0.55, 0.29),
  ancestry_raw = c("european", "African American or Afro-Caribbean",
                    "east_asian", "South Asian", "HIS", "mid")
)

df_messy$ancestry <- pgscatalog_match(df_messy$ancestry_raw, quiet = TRUE)
df_messy[, c("ancestry_raw", "ancestry")]
#>               ancestry_raw ancestry
#> 1                european      EUR
#> 2 African American or Afro-Caribbean AAM
#> 3                east_asian      EAS
#> 4                South Asian      SAS
#> 5                     HIS       HIS
#> 6                     mid       MID
```

What if my data uses full ancestry names instead of acronyms?

For exact full names, `pgscatalog_match()` handles this directly. For cases where you want to inspect or customise the mapping, you can also join against `pgscatalog_ancestry_info()` manually:

```
raw <- data.frame(
  sample_id = 1:3,
  ancestry_long = c("European", "African unspecified", "East Asian")
)

info <- pgscatalog_ancestry_info()
merged <- merge(raw, info[, c("ancestry", "acronym")],
  by.x = "ancestry_long", by.y = "ancestry")
merged
#>               ancestry_long sample_id acronym
#> 1 African unspecified         2      AFR
#> 2           East Asian         3      EAS
#> 3           European         1      EUR
```

Citing this package

If you use `pgscatalogcolors` in a publication, please cite it as follows:

```
citation("pgscatalogcolors")
#> To cite package 'pgscatalogcolors' in publications use:
#>
#> Wolford B (2026). _pgscatalogcolors: Color Palettes for PGS Catalog
#> Ancestry Groups_. R package version 0.1.0,
#> <https://github.com/bnwolford/pgscatalogcolors>.
#>
#> A BibTeX entry for LaTeX users is
```

```
#>
#>   @Manual{,
#>     title = {{pgscatalogcolors}: Color Palettes for PGS Catalog Ancestry Groups},
#>     author = {Brooke N. Welford},
#>     year = {2026},
#>     note = {R package version 0.1.0},
#>     url = {https://github.com/bnwelford/pgscatalogcolors},
#>   }
```

You can also retrieve the citation in BibTeX format:

```
toBibtex(citation("pgscatalogcolors"))
@Manual{,
  title = {{pgscatalogcolors}: Color Palettes for PGS Catalog Ancestry Groups},
  author = {Brooke N. Welford},
  year = {2026},
  note = {R package version 0.1.0},
  url = {https://github.com/bnwelford/pgscatalogcolors},
}
```